



Original Ship = Continuous Ship

This is not a story of a ship crashing into itself; it seems fairly clear that



Original Ship = Reconstructed Ship



Continuous Ship $\neq$ Reconstructed Ship

The problem, though, is that these three claims are inconsistent. This is due to the

transitivity of identity: if $A=B$, and $B=C$, then $A=C$.

It appears that we must reject one of the following two claims:

But if we reject the first claim, then it seems that the materialist must give up on the idea that people exist for more than a fraction of a second — after all, we are constantly gaining and losing parts!

Either way we go, it looks like we get a problem for the
materialist believer in life after death.

Original Ship = Continuous Ship

Original Ship = Reconstructed Ship

If we reject the second claim,
then it seems that the
materialist must give up on the
idea of resurrection as
reassembly. If Reconstructed
Ship is not Original Ship, why
would your reconstructed body
be your body?



Originalship = Derivativship



Original Ship = Registered Ship



Contracting Ship $\neq$ Registered Ship

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OriginalShip = CopyingShip



OriginalShip=RestrictedShip

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Ship is not Original Ship, why

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would your recollections be

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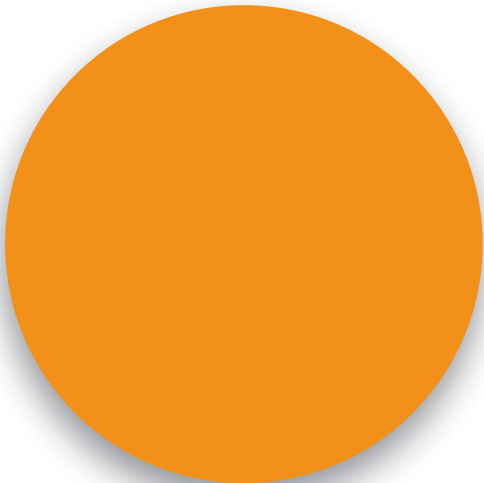
idea of resurrection as

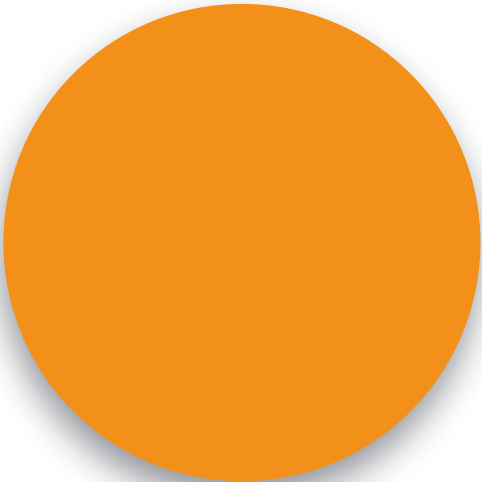
be your body?

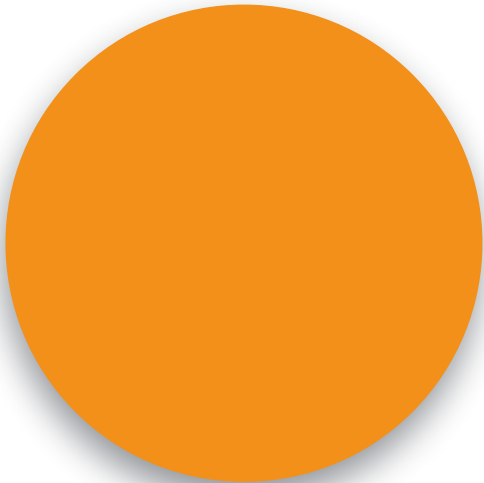


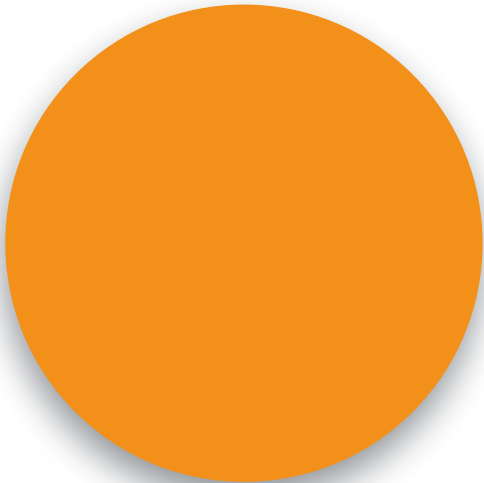
Matters are less clear when it comes to our other answers

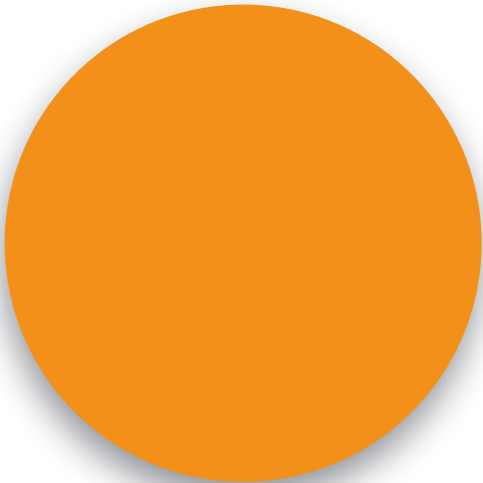
to the survival question.











physical things.

These views differ in important ways, but they all agree

that your survival depends on the survival of a certain

that the relevant physical objects won't survive your

Views of this kind face an obvious problem in making

death $\rightarrow$ and so that, if one of the above views is right,

bodies decay (or are cremated). Doesn't that just show

sense of the possibility of life after death. After death

you won't?

This is a problem which has long troubled philosophers in

the christian tradition.

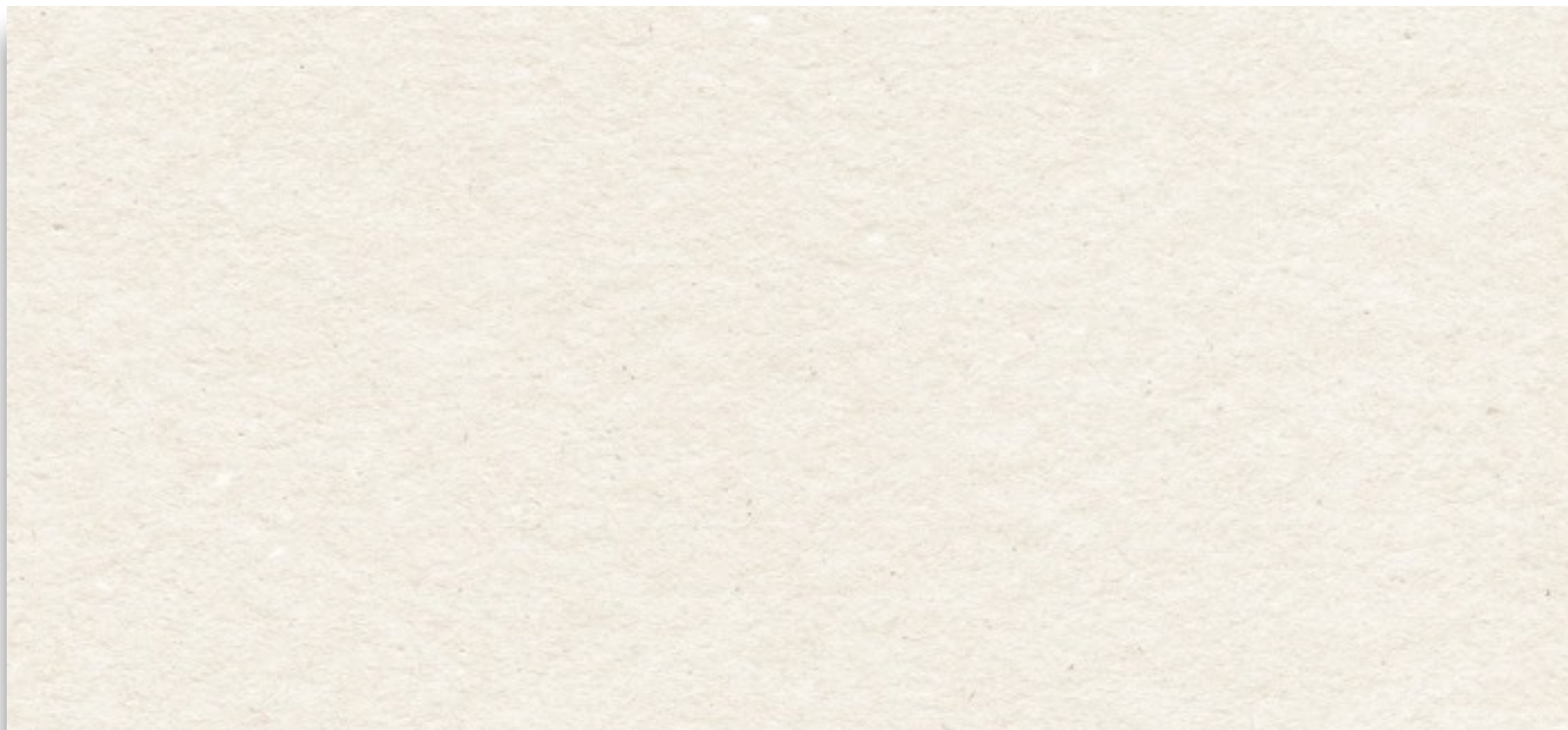
This might sound surprising. After all, don't Christians

believe that one's immaterial soul is enough for life after

death?

In fact, this is not the traditional Christian view. The

following quote from Aquinas is representative:



which was made. This card is placed in

this life, not in the life after death.

Sandwiches are not refined."

united these 150 bodies. For the wise there

'The necessity of holding their position arises

and this is effected by the sand being

from this — that may obtain the last end for

it is necessary for the soldier to rise again;

would be no resistor properly speaking, in the

— if life after death were simply the continued existence

This is also implied by the use of the word "reaction"

of an immaterial soul, then there would be nothing

needing to be 'raised up.'

How can we make sense of this idea, given obvious facts

about the decay of bodies and brains after death?

the material of which they were composed does not cease

resemble our bodies out of the matter from which they

time of resurrection our bodies could be reassembled by

were composed when we were living.

to exist. Surely an omnipotent being could then simply

One idea (defended by Aquinas and others) is that at the

God. While it is true that our bodies decay after death,

Would this be enough for God to bring our bodies back

into existence?

There are various problems of detail here. (For example,

seem to make certain bits of matter part of more than

Aquinas worried a lot about cannibalism, which would

purely philosophical problem with this idea.

one person.) But we have already seen that there is a

Remember the case of the Ship of Theseus. We saw that

how our bodies could continue to exist over time despite

gaining and losing parts.)

there is good reason to believe that Original Ship =

Continuous Ship. (If this were not so, it is hard to see

Reconstructed Ship. And if this is so, that would seem to

imply that if a material thing breaks into its constituent

parts, representing these parts does not bring the original

But we also saw that if this is true, $\text{OriginalShip} \neq$

material thing back into existence.

that would not be enough to bring that everybody (or

And that seems to imply that, even if God did raise me

the parts which formerly composed some body (or brain),

brain) back into existence.

This is a serious problem for the idea of "resurrection" as

readily.' Is there any other way to make sense of the

idea of a bodily resurrection?